

German A1 – Sentence Structure

Essential Word Order Rules & Core Grammar Foundations

PART 1 OF 2

1. Normal Sentence (Declarative)

🔑 Verb = Position 2

Subject + Verb (Pos. 2) + Object / Other Information

Ich lerne Deutsch.

I learn German.

Ich trinke Kaffee.

I drink coffee.

2. W-Question (Open Question)

🔑 W-Word → Verb → Subject

W-Word + Verb (Pos. 2) + Subject + ... ?

Wo wohnst du?

Where do you live?

Was machst du?

What are you doing?

Wann arbeitest du?

When do you work?

3. Yes / No Question (Closed Question)

🔑 Verb = Position 1

Verb (Pos. 1) + Subject + ... ?

Lernst du Deutsch?

Do you learn German?

Arbeitest du heute?

Are you working today?

Hast du Zeit?

Do you have time?

4. Modal Verb

🔑 Modal = Pos. 2 | Main Verb = END

Subject + Modal Verb (Pos. 2) + ... + Main Verb (Infinitive - END).

Ich kann Deutsch sprechen.

I can speak German.

Ich muss heute arbeiten.

I have to work today.

Ich möchte Kaffee trinken.

I would like to drink coffee.

5. Separable Verb (Trennbare Verben)

🔑 Verb Stem = Pos. 2 | Prefix = END

Subject + Verb Stem (Pos. 2) + ... + Prefix (END).

Ich stehe um 7 Uhr auf.

I get up at 7 o'clock.

Ich rufe meinen Freund an.

I call my friend.

Ich kaufe heute ein.

I shop today.

German A1 — Inversion, Conjunctions & Summary

PART 2 OF 2

Advanced Positioning & Core Cheat Sheet

6. Time / Place First (Inversion)

🔑 Verb STAY Position 2

Time / Place + Verb (Pos. 2) + Subject + ...

Morgen arbeite ich.

Tomorrow I work.

Heute lerne ich Deutsch.

Today I study German.

In Berlin wohnt mein Bruder.

My brother lives in Berlin.

Normal: Ich (S) + arbeite (V) + morgen (T).

Inverted: Morgen (T) + arbeite (V) + ich (S).

7. Coordinating Conjunctions (ADUSO)

🔑 Normal Word Order Retained

Main Clause + Conjunction (und, oder, aber, denn) + Subject + Verb (Pos. 2) + ...

Ich lerne Deutsch und ich arbeite.

I learn German and I work.

Ich möchte Kaffee, aber ich habe kein Geld.

I want coffee, but I have no money.

Ich bleibe zu Hause, denn ich bin müde.

I stay home because I am tired.

⚠️ **Important Note:** Subordinating conjunctions (*weil, dass, wenn*) send the conjugated verb to the **very end** (e.g., ...*weil ich arbeiten möchte*).

🧠 German A1 Core Formula Cheat Sheet

#	Structure Type	Sentence Formula	Key Takeaway
1	Normal Statement	S + V + O / Info	Verb is strictly at Position 2.
2	W-Question	W-Word + V + S + ...?	Verb follows the W-Word directly.
3	Yes/No Question	V + S + ...?	Verb moves to Position 1.
4	Modal Verb	S + Modal + ... + Main Verb _{inf}	Modal at Pos 2, Main Verb at the END.
5	Separable Verb	S + Verb Stem + ... + Prefix	Stem at Pos 2, Prefix splits to the END.
6	Time/Place First	Time/Place + V + S + ...	Verb stays Pos 2; Subject and Time swap.
7	Conjunction (ADUSO)	Clause + Conj + S + V + ...	Position 0; main clause word order holds.